

GOLDEN SPRING

Grand Seiko

62GS Sakura-Wakaba SBGH376

Grand Seiko's first regularly produced yellow-gold 62GS uses precious metal less like decoration and more like a lighting instrument. The bezel-free 38 mm case exposes broad Zaratsu-polished planes, letting every edge flash against brushed flanks. Its Sakura-Wakaba dial captures the brief overlap of pale blossoms and fresh green leaves, giving the gold a surprisingly springlike softness. Inside, caliber 9S85 beats at a brisk 36,000 vibrations per hour and runs for 55 hours. It is nature poetry with sharp tailoring, and far more interesting than another predictable champagne dial.

GILDED STRIPES

Piaget

Polo 79 Two-Tone

Two-tone usually means steel taking a supporting role. Piaget dispenses with the economy and pairs white gold with yellow gold instead. Brushed white-gold surfaces run through the 38 mm case, solid-gold dial and integrated bracelet, interrupted by polished yellow-gold gadroons like pinstripes on a very expensive suit. Beneath the retro glamour, the 2.35 mm caliber 1200P1 uses a gold micro-rotor to keep the entire watch just 7.45 mm thick. It is pure 1980s jet-set excess, executed with enough precision to make nostalgia feel current.

